to represent their societies and make sure they are protected, growing, moving forward.... We share those same goals at YouTube. That type of partnership is very collaborative. Again, we're very transparent about how YouTube works. We invest time in sharing that information, in soliciting feedback and taking input in terms of what is important to our government stakeholders. It's our responsibility to, first and foremost, follow the laws in all the countries in which we operate, but also be close and proactive partners in this shared objective. One of the things that is important to governments, and particularly important to the Indian government under the leadership of PM [Narendra Modi], is the growth of the creator economy.

Q. Did you imagine YouTube to be the way it is today when you started out on your journey 15-20 years ago?

We're celebrating our 20th birthday this year. I had been working with YouTube before—either I or YouTube were part of Google. I helped sell a company called DoubleClick to Google many years ago and it was around the time that Google also acquired YouTube. YouTube was a small startup in the Silicon Valley; they rented space above a pizza parlour. They were a client of mine at DoubleClick—in fact, one of my largest clients. Nobody, including the founders, could have predicted what YouTube is today. But you could see, even from the very early days, that they were on to something. All these things seem like overnight successes. But they have been years in the making. I mentioned YouTube being the new television for young people. Well, that didn't happen just overnight. It was the result of hard work and big bets we've made on technology. At the end of the day, YouTube is a technology company. Our job really is to build this stage and then allow our creators to shine on it—that's where the success of YouTube comes from.

Q. You mentioned how AI helps you monitor content. What are the other ways in which technology, including machine learning and AI, is being applied to enhance user experience?

AI really is foundational to how YouTube works. We have been investing in it for over a decade. When you open the YouTube app, those recommendations that you see are based on your personal interest. That's the power of AI at work, like machine learning technologies that are giving you the best possible videos to watch at that moment in time. Fast forward to today. YouTube really sits in a very interesting place when it comes to the big paradigm shift that is AI. We work very closely with sister companies like Google DeepMind on AI technology. But we're also a company that faces the creative industry every single day. I therefore see AI as a tool that is going to enhance human creativity, not replace it. And that's very important. Ultimately, it will be a profound way to think about how you should see our investment in AI going forward.

> **"Everybody thinks of YouTube, as something you consume on your phones. But our fastest-growing surface is actually the television screen, lots of news content, including your channels"**

> **"We have been investing in machine learning and AI for a very long time. And one of the areas where we use it actually is in content moderation"**

Q. Can you give some examples of how this works?

We have this new feature called Dream Screen, which integrates Google DeepMind's Veo model with YouTube engineering. So, when you open YouTube, hit the plus button and start creating a video, you can enter a simple text prompt suggesting that instead of a conference room, have a park, maybe with some trees and birds and a stream, and, instantaneously, in a matter of seconds, that video is generated. That's the vision of really letting AI be a tool to empower creators and further democratise creation.

Another feature that is particularly relevant for a multilingual country like India is something we call Multi-language Audio. It recognises that, today, the barrier for a YouTube creator to grow their audience is not geographic, it's actually language. As an English language creator, you may have Hindi or Bengali speaking fans, but they can't access you because you don't speak their language. With AI, we could translate that instantaneously, using your voice, your inflections, so that you can sound like yourself in all these other languages. That's the power of AI in the hands of the creators.

Q. YouTube Shorts has been extremely successful. You also see people watching full-length videos. What mix works best?

That's what's sort of amazing about it. YouTube is a place where, whether it's a 15-second short or a 15-minute traditional YouTube vlog or a 15-hour livestream with your favourite gamer, all of it is there and become part of the user expectation. This is especially true of the young viewers who have grown up on YouTube. Whether watching it on their mobile phones or on their television screens, they can see all kinds of content in one place. That again is core to our vision, which is to be the leading service for watching, creating and sharing video content, and it can be all of these different types of formats, whatever your interest happens to be on that day. ■